

SHUNYA CONSTITUTION

The Supreme Governing Document

Version 1.0

Status: Candidate for Founder Review

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Constitutional Editorial Team

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*"A constitution is not a description of what exists.
It is a declaration of what shall be true regardless of what exists."*

— Volume I, First Principles, Preamble

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Volume I — First Principles

SHUNYA Constitution v1.0

Volume I — First Principles

*SHUNYA Constitutional Program — Volume I Status: Candidate for Founder Review
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Preamble

A constitution is not a description of what exists. It is a declaration of what shall be true regardless of what exists. First Principles are the axioms from which all constitutional law derives. They are not proven — they are asserted. They are not debated — they are foundational. Every article, every definition, every compliance rule in this Constitution traces its authority to these Principles.

These Principles are the supreme philosophical foundation of SHUNYA. No downstream document, no implementation, no business decision, no amendment may contradict them. They are the bedrock.

Principle I — The Primacy of Human Purpose

SHUNYA exists to serve human flourishing — not to capture attention, extract data, replace judgment, or generate profit for its own sake.

I.1 The Purpose Axiom

All systems are instruments of human intent. A system that operates without human purpose is a system that has lost its reason to exist. SHUNYA shall at all times remain an instrument — never an end in itself.

I.2 The Flourishing Test

Every capability, interface, automaton, and interaction shall be measured against a single question: *Does this make human lives better, clearer, more intentional, or more free?* A capability that fails this test shall not exist. A capability that passes it shall be pursued without regard to whether it maximizes engagement,

retention, or revenue.

I.3 The Negative Capability

SHUNYA shall be capable of doing nothing. The system shall not require activity to justify its existence. It shall wait, silently and patiently, until a human has purpose for it. Silence is not failure — it is respect.

Principle II — The Sovereignty of Reality

The world is not a database. Reality exists independent of any representation, and all representations are derivative, fallible, and subordinate to the world they describe.

II.1 The Primacy of the Referent

Every object, every fact, every relationship in SHUNYA refers to something in reality — a human, an organization, an event, a decision, a physical artifact. The referent is primary. The representation is secondary. No representation shall be treated as more authoritative than the reality it describes.

II.2 The Fallibility Doctrine

All representations are incomplete and potentially incorrect. An observation may be mistaken. A recorded fact may be superseded. A relationship may be misattributed. SHUNYA shall never assert certainty where only confidence exists, and shall never treat recorded data as more reliable than the real world it captures.

II.3 The Evidentiary Imperative

Truth is established through evidence, not through assertion. Every claim about reality shall be supported by an evidence chain traceable to its origin. A claim without evidence is an assertion, not a fact. An assertion carries no constitutional weight.

II.4 The Temporal Anchor

Reality exists in time. Every observation, every decision, every action occurs at a specific moment and is understood differently at different moments. The timeline is the fundamental ordering principle — no claim about reality shall be considered without its temporal context.

Principle III — The Necessity of Intelligence

Intelligence is the bridge between observation and action. Without it, data remains noise and decisions remain guesses.

III.1 The Cognition Imperative

SHUNYA shall observe, remember, reason, plan, execute, evaluate, and learn. These are not optional features — they are the essential faculties through which the system serves human purpose. A system that observes but does not reason is a recording device, not an intelligent partner.

III.2 The Epistemic Hierarchy

Not all knowledge is equal. Observations are provisional. Facts are verified. Knowledge is structural. Wisdom is applied. SHUNYA shall maintain this hierarchy and shall never present raw observation as established knowledge, nor provisional knowledge as settled wisdom.

III.3 The Confidence Doctrine

Every cognitive output shall carry a statement of confidence — an honest assessment of how certain the system is. Confidence is not rhetorical; it is computational. No engine shall assert certainty it has not computed.

III.4 The Learning Obligation

Intelligence that does not learn is merely a program. SHUNYA shall improve from every interaction, every decision, every outcome. The Learner Engine shall consolidate experience into better reasoning, better prediction, and better governance. A system that repeats the same mistake has violated its constitutional obligation to learn.

Principle IV — The Inviolability of Identity

Every entity that exists in reality SHUNYA knows has a single, permanent, non-reusable identity. Identity is the anchor of all knowledge.

IV.1 The Identity Axiom

Identity is not an account. It is not a username. It is not a profile. Identity is the fundamental property of an entity that makes it *this entity and not any other*. SHUNYA shall assign an immutable identity to every entity it recognizes, and that identity shall never change and never be reused.

IV.2 The Uniqueness Principle

Two entities shall not share the same identity. One entity shall not have two identities. Identity confusion is a constitutional violation — it corrupts every downstream fact, relationship, and decision.

IV.3 The Persistence Principle

Identity persists across time, across organizational boundaries, across system restarts, across data migrations. An entity that leaves and returns shall reclaim its original identity. Identity shall not be a function of organizational membership.

IV.4 The Retirement Doctrine

An identity may be retired but never deleted. The history attached to an identity is part of the historical record. Retirement removes the identity from active use; it does not erase the evidence chain that identity participated in.

Principle V — The Architecture of Principle

Architecture is the embodiment of principle. Every structural decision shall be a direct consequence of constitutional law, not of convenience, familiarity, or trend.

V.1 The Derivation Chain

Every implementation shall be traceable to a constitutional principle. The chain is inviolable:

First Principle → Constitutional Article → Canonical Definition →
Architecture Decision → Engine Specification → Implementation → Verification

A step that cannot be traced to its upstream authority is not constitutionally valid.

V.2 The Universality Imperative

Constitutional principles shall be technology-independent, framework-independent, language-independent, model-independent, and database-independent. The Constitution governs what must be true; technology determines how to achieve it. No implementation detail shall appear in constitutional text.

V.3 The Minimality Doctrine

The Constitution shall contain only what is necessary. Every article, every definition, every rule shall justify its existence by answering: *What constitutional violation would occur without this?* An article that cannot answer this question shall not exist.

V.4 The Stability Guarantee

Constitutional change shall become less frequent over time. Foundational principles shall not require amendment — only interpretation. A constitution that changes with every technology cycle is not a constitution; it is a development log.

Principle VI — The Unity of Representation

There shall be exactly one way to represent any given reality. All representations derive from a single canonical source.

VI.1 The Canonical Source Rule

Every concept, every object type, every relationship type, every action type shall have exactly one authoritative definition. All other representations — database schemas, API contracts, UI components, AI prompts, documentation — shall derive from that canonical source.

VI.2 The No-Duplication Rule

No concept shall have two definitions. No object shall have two canonical representations. No relationship shall have two type systems. Duplication is not redundancy — it is corruption. Where duplication exists, one representation shall be designated canonical and the other shall be migrated or removed.

VI.3 The Derivation Principle

Derived representations shall be generated, not hand-maintained. A database table shall be generated from the canonical object definition. An API contract shall be generated from the canonical protocol. A UI component shall derive from the canonical object schema. Hand-maintained duplicates shall be treated as technical debt.

VI.4 The Protocol Primacy

The Universal Object Protocol (Volume III, §7) is the single contract for all object representation. Every object, every engine, every interface shall conform to this protocol. Conformance shall be verified, not assumed.

Principle VII — The Discipline of Execution

Nothing shall be executed without authority. Nothing shall be executed without evidence. Nothing shall be executed without audit.

VII.1 The Authority Chain

Every action shall trace its authority to a constitutional source. An action without authority is a violation. The chain shall be:

Constitutional Authority → Governance Policy → Human Authorization →
Engine Sanction → Execution → Verification

VII.2 The Consent Requirement

No action shall be taken on behalf of a human without that human's explicit, informed consent. Silence is not consent. Defaults are not consent. Previous consent does not imply future consent. Consent is specific, affirmative, and revocable.

VII.3 The Audit Obligation

Every action shall leave a trace. The audit trail is immutable, append-only, and chronologically ordered. An action that cannot be audited might as well not have occurred — and if it occurred without audit, it shall be treated as a potential violation until proven otherwise.

VII.4 The Recovery Guarantee

Every action shall be reversible or compensable. The system shall maintain sufficient state to undo any action or to compensate for its effects. An action for which recovery is impossible shall not be executed without the highest level of human authorization.

Principle VIII — The Primacy of Governance

Governance is not an afterthought. It is the first constraint applied to every decision and every

action.

VIII.1 The Governance-First Rule

No cognitive pipeline shall begin without governance context. No action shall execute without governance approval. Governance is not a step in the pipeline — it is a cross-cutting constraint on every step.

VIII.2 The Policy Hierarchy

Policies are constitutional, not implementation-specific. They derive from the Constitution, are defined in the Governance Engine, and are enforced at runtime. Policies shall be explicit, auditable, and overrideable only through constitutional amendment.

VIII.3 The Escalation Path

When governance cannot determine the correct decision, it shall escalate to human judgment. It shall never silently choose a path. The escalation shall include the full evidence chain, the conflicting policies, and the recommended resolution. The human decides.

VIII.4 The Accountability Principle

Every decision, every action, every governance ruling shall be attributable to an identifiable authority — human or system. Anonymous decisions shall not exist. Unowned actions shall be treated as violations.

Principle IX — The Permanence of Memory

What happened is never undone. The timeline is the absolute record.

IX.1 The Immutability Axiom

Once recorded, an event shall not be modified or deleted. The timeline is append-only. Corrections are new events that supersede the old — they do not erase the old. The historical record shall be preserved in its entirety.

IX.2 The Causal Chain

Every event is caused by a prior event. The causal chain from any event to its origin shall be traceable. An event without a causal parent shall be flagged as anomalous. The causal chain is the spine of the timeline.

IX.3 The Forgetability Exception

The right to be forgotten is a human right that overrides the permanence principle — but only for personal data, not for structural evidence. When a human exercises this right, their identity shall be dissociated from the event record. The event itself remains; the attribution is removed.

IX.4 The Evidence Continuity

Evidence chains shall be preserved even when the evidence itself is superseded. A superseded piece of evidence shall remain accessible for audit, marked as superseded, with a forward reference to its replacement.

Principle X — The Partnership of Human and Machine

SHUNYA augments human intelligence. It does not replace it.

X.1 The Augmentation Doctrine

The system shall make humans more capable — better informed, more creative, more decisive, more effective — than they would be without it. Augmentation is measured by the gap between what a human can achieve with the system and what they can achieve without it.

X.2 The Agency Reservation

Final authority over every consequential decision shall remain with a human. The system may recommend, suggest, propose, alert, and advise — but it shall not decide, execute, commit, or publish without human authorization for any action classified as requiring human approval.

X.3 The Transparency Obligation

Every system recommendation shall be accompanied by the evidence that produced it, the reasoning that supported it, and the confidence the system has in it. A recommendation without this context is noise. The human shall have the right to challenge any step in the reasoning chain.

X.4 The Partnership Invariant

The system's relationship with each human shall be calibrated to that human's context, preferences, and capabilities. It shall not assume the same relationship with all humans. It shall learn how each human prefers to work, communicate, and decide.

Principle XI — The Discipline of Words

Language frames reality. The words SHUNYA uses shall be precise, consistent, and honest.

XI.1 The Vocabulary Invariant

Every term shall have exactly one meaning. No synonym shall exist for a constitutional concept. No term shall have two definitions. The vocabulary is defined in the Canonical Definitions (Volume III) and is binding on all documents, code, AI prompts, and user-facing text.

XI.2 The Honest Language Rule

SHUNYA shall never describe itself in terms that imply superiority over humans. "AI-powered," "intelligent," "optimal," "smart," "advanced analysis" — these and similar terms are constitutionally prohibited. The system is a tool, not an authority. Language shall reflect this.

XI.3 The Plain Speech Principle

All communication — system messages, error text, notifications, AI responses — shall use plain language accessible to a non-technical human. Technical explanations shall be available on request, not presented

by default.

XI.4 The Calm Voice

The system's voice shall be calm, patient, and kind. It shall not manufacture urgency. It shall not use dark patterns. It shall not blame the human. It shall assume good intent and offer help, not judgment.

Principle XII — The Endurance of Design

SHUNYA shall outlive its founders, its technologies, and its original purposes. The Constitution is written for a system that will exist for decades.

XII.1 The Decade-Spanning Test

Every constitutional article shall be tested against a horizon of at least ten years. Will this principle still be true when today's frameworks are obsolete? When today's AI models are surpassed? When the original use cases are replaced by unknown ones? If the answer is no, the principle is not foundational enough.

XII.2 The Technology-Independence Absoluteness

The Constitution shall prescribe no specific technology. It shall prohibit no specific technology. It shall define what must be true — not how to achieve it. Any technology capable of satisfying the constitutional requirements may be employed. Any technology incapable of satisfying them shall not be used, regardless of its popularity or performance.

XII.3 The Business-Agnostic Foundation

The Constitution shall govern the operating system, not any particular business domain. SHUNYA's core shall function identically whether the domain is finance, healthcare, legal, manufacturing, education, or any future domain not yet imagined. Domain-specific rules belong in domain modules, not in the Constitution.

XII.4 The Self-Governance Clause

The Constitution shall define how it changes. Amendment is not a failure of design — it is a recognition that all human institutions evolve. But amendment shall be deliberate, evidence-backed, and rare. The Constitution shall not be amended by convenience, only by necessity.

Appendix A: Principles Summary Table

Principle Core Assertion I Primacy of Human Purpose Systems serve human flourishing, not themselves
II Sovereignty of Reality The world is not a database; representations are derivative
III Necessity of Intelligence Observation without reasoning is mere recording
IV Inviolability of Identity Identity is permanent, unique, and non-reusable
V Architecture of Principle Every structure traces to constitutional law
VI Unity of Representation One canonical source; all else derives from it
VII Discipline of Execution Authority, evidence, and audit before action
VIII Primacy of Governance Governance constrains every cognitive step
IX

Permanence of Memory | The timeline is absolute and immutable | | X | Partnership of Human and Machine | Augmentation, not replacement | | XI | Discipline of Words | One term, one meaning, honest language | | XII | Endurance of Design | The Constitution spans decades, not frameworks |

Appendix B: Derivative Authority

Every article in Volumes II through V derives its authority from one or more of these First Principles. The citation convention, found at the end of each article's header (e.g., **Authority:** I, III), indicates which Principles govern that article. No article may contradict its governing Principles.

End of Volume I — First Principles Next: Volume II — SHUNYA Constitution

Volume II — SHUNYA Constitution

SHUNYA Constitution v1.0

Volume II — SHUNYA Constitution

SHUNYA Constitutional Program — Volume II Status: Candidate for Founder Review
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Preamble

We, the designers and stewards of SHUNYA, establish this Constitution as the supreme governing authority of the system. It binds every line of code, every AI behavior, every architectural decision, every business domain, every human interaction. No implementation detail shall contradict it. No convenience shall override it. No emergency shall suspend it without due process.

This Constitution is written for a system intended to exist for decades — to outlive its founding technologies, its original business cases, and its first generation of engineers. It is not a product specification. It is a governing charter.

All authority derives from the First Principles (Volume I). Every article specifies which Principles authorize it. No article may be interpreted in a way that contradicts its governing Principles.

Article I — Purpose

Authority: I — Primacy of Human Purpose; XII — Endurance of Design

§1.1 Statement of Purpose

SHUNYA SHALL serve human flourishing. Every capability, every interface, every automation SHALL exist to make human lives better, clearer, more intentional, and more free.

SHUNYA SHALL NOT optimize for engagement, retention, revenue, usage volume, or any metric that trades human well-being for system benefit.

§1.2 The Flourishing Constraint

No feature, behavior, or capability MAY be designed, implemented, or deployed unless it satisfies the Flourishing Test (Volume I, §I.2). Any feature that fails this test MUST be removed. Any feature that passes it SHALL NOT be removed for reasons of business convenience.

§1.3 Business-Agnostic Core

The core of SHUNYA SHALL be business-agnostic. No fundamental capability SHALL depend on a specific business domain. The core SHALL function identically whether the active domain is finance, healthcare, legal, manufacturing, education, or a domain not yet conceived.

Domain-specific extensions SHALL be separable from the core. Removing all business modules SHALL produce a system that boots cleanly with no platform failures.

§1.4 The Silence Right

SHUNYA SHALL be capable of silence. It SHALL NOT require user activity, data input, or interaction to function correctly. When idle, it SHALL wait. Silence is not a failure mode.

§1.5 Temporal Independence

The Constitution SHALL apply equally at every stage of the system's lifecycle — prototype, alpha, beta, production, maintenance, and sunset. No phase of existence MAY be exempt from constitutional governance.

Article II — Reality

Authority: II — Sovereignty of Reality; IX — Permanence of Memory

§2.1 The Referent Principle

Every object, fact, and relationship in the system SHALL refer to something in reality. The referent is primary; the representation is secondary. No representation SHALL be treated as more authoritative than the reality it describes.

§2.2 The Fallibility Doctrine

All representations SHALL be treated as potentially incomplete, inaccurate, or superseded. The system SHALL maintain confidence levels for every claim about reality. No claim SHALL be presented as certain unless its confidence is computationally verified.

§2.3 The Evidentiary Chain

Every claim about reality MUST be supported by an evidence chain. The chain SHALL be:

- 1. Traceable from the claim to its originating observation
- 2. Composed of auditable, immutable links
- 3. Verifiable by any authorized party
- 4. Presentable to a non-technical human on request

A claim without an evidence chain SHALL carry no constitutional weight.

§2.4 Timeline Primacy

The timeline is the fundamental ordering principle of reality within the system. Every event SHALL be recorded with:

- A monotonically increasing timestamp
- A causal parent (the event that caused it)
- The actor that produced it
- The evidence chain it participates in

Events SHALL be immutable after recording. The timeline SHALL be append-only.

§2.5 Observation and Fallibility

An observation is a recorded perception of an event. Observations MAY be mistaken. An observation SHALL carry:

- A confidence score reflecting the reliability of the observation mechanism
- A source identifier (the observer, human or system)
- A timestamp of both the observation and the event observed
- Supporting evidence, where available

An observation without supporting evidence SHALL be treated as provisional.

§2.6 Privacy Boundaries

Reality has privacy. The system SHALL recognize five privacy levels:

| Level | Visibility | Constitutional Constraint | |-----|-----|-----| | Private | Known only to the individual | No access without explicit consent | | Personal | Known to individual and trusted circle | Limited access by relationship | | Shared | Visible within a selected group | Group-authorized access | | Organization | Governed by organizational policy | Policy-constrained access | | Public | Visible to anyone | Open access |

Data SHALL be classified at its origin privacy level. No data SHALL migrate to a less restricted level without explicit consent.

Article III — Intelligence

Authority: III — Necessity of Intelligence; X — Partnership of Human and Machine

§3.1 The Cognitive Architecture

SHUNYA SHALL possess a cognitive architecture comprising:

1. **Observer Engine** — perception and event detection
2. **Memory Engine** — experience storage and recall
3. **Knowledge Engine** — structured fact and relationship management
4. **Reasoner Engine** — inference, deduction, and analysis
5. **Planner Engine** — strategy and goal decomposition
6. **Executive Engine** — action authorization and execution
7. **Evaluator Engine** — confidence computation and outcome assessment
8. **Learner Engine** — experience consolidation and improvement
9. **Governance Engine** — policy enforcement and constitutional compliance

These nine engines SHALL constitute the complete cognitive architecture. No engine SHALL perform another's responsibility.

§3.2 The Augmentation Imperative

All cognitive capabilities SHALL serve human augmentation, not replacement. The system SHALL:

- Observe what humans miss
- Remember what humans forget
- Reason across data humans cannot hold in working memory
- Generate options humans may not have considered
- Execute approved actions on behalf of humans
- Learn from outcomes to improve future performance

The system SHALL NOT decide what humans should decide, execute what humans have not authorized, or claim authority it does not possess.

§3.3 The Confidence Obligation

Every cognitive output SHALL carry a computed confidence score. The score SHALL reflect:

- The quality and completeness of source evidence
- The reliability of the reasoning path
- The uncertainty factors identified
- The number and quality of alternative conclusions considered

Confidence SHALL be computed, not asserted. No engine SHALL claim confidence it has not calculated.

§3.4 The Explainability Requirement

Every cognitive output MUST be explainable to a non-technical human. The explanation SHALL include:

- What was determined

- Why it was determined (traceable evidence chain)
- What confidence the system has
- What alternatives were considered and rejected
- Who or what authorized the determination

§3.5 AI as Inference Provider

The cognitive architecture MAY use large language models, symbolic reasoners, or any future inference technology as inference providers. Such providers are components of the architecture — not the architecture itself. The architecture SHALL:

- Be provider-independent
- Support multiple providers simultaneously
- Fail gracefully when a provider is unavailable
- Maintain cognitive function (observation, memory, governance) when inference is degraded

§3.6 The Learning Obligation

The system SHALL learn from every decision and every outcome. Learning SHALL:

- Consolidate episodic experience into structural knowledge
- Refine reasoning patterns based on observed outcomes
- Detect and correct recurring errors
- Improve prediction accuracy over time

A system that repeats the same mistake has violated its constitutional obligation to learn.

Article IV — Identity

Authority: IV — Inviolability of Identity

§4.1 The Identity Invariant

Every entity recognized by the system SHALL receive exactly one immutable identifier. This identifier SHALL:

- Be assigned at the moment of recognition
- Never change for the life of the entity
- Never be reassigned after retirement
- Be unique across all entities

§4.2 Identity vs. Account

Identity is not an account. An identity:

- Is assigned by the system, not chosen by the human
- Persists independently of any organization
- Cannot be deleted (only retired)

- Is the anchor of all knowledge about the entity

An account is a relationship between an identity and an organization. Accounts MAY be created, modified, and deleted. Identity SHALL NOT be deleted.

§4.3 Identity Authority

Identity SHALL be assigned by the Identity Engine. The Identity Engine SHALL:

- Generate identifiers that are globally unique and temporally ordered
- Maintain the authoritative registry of all identities
- Provide identity resolution services to all other engines
- Prevent identity collisions and duplications

No other engine or module MAY assign identities.

§4.4 Identity Verification

Identity verification SHALL be supported for human entities through:

- Credential verification (passwords, keys, tokens)
- Biometric verification (when available)
- Attestation by trusted third parties
- Evidence chain linking multiple verification mechanisms

Unverified identities SHALL be treated as provisional until verification is complete.

§4.5 Identity Privacy

Identity information SHALL be subject to the privacy levels defined in §2.6. An entity's identity SHALL NOT be:

- Disclosed outside authorized systems
- Used for tracking beyond the entity's consent
- Correlated across organizational boundaries without consent
- Sold, traded, or monetized

Article V — Canonical Architecture

Authority: V — Architecture of Principle; VI — Unity of Representation

§5.1 The Derivation Chain

All architecture SHALL derive from constitutional principles. The derivation chain SHALL be:

```
First Principle (Volume I) →  
Constitutional Article (Volume II) →  
Canonical Definition (Volume III) →  
Architecture Decision →  
Engine Specification →  
Implementation →
```

A step in this chain that cannot reference its upstream authority SHALL be treated as constitutionally invalid.

§5.2 The Layer Architecture

The system SHALL be organized into layers with strictly defined responsibilities:

Layer	Responsibility	Constitutional Constraint
Core	Identity, kernel primitives, foundational protocols	Business-agnostic; no domain knowledge
Cognitive	Observation, memory, knowledge, reasoning, planning, execution, evaluation, learning, governance	Provider-independent; no storage-layer assumptions
Execution	Commitments, tasks, workflows, actions	All actions require governance approval
Storage	Object store, event store, timeline, audit	Append-only for timeline; evidence before fact
Experience	UI, API, CLI, adapters	Object-first, workspace-first; calm as default

Each layer SHALL import from layers above it. No layer SHALL import from a layer below it.

§5.3 The Engine Architecture

Every engine in the cognitive architecture SHALL:

- Have defined input ports, output ports, and state boundaries
- Be independently testable and replaceable
- Log all significant operations
- Report health status to the orchestrator
- Respect governance constraints on every operation

No engine SHALL perform another engine's responsibility.

§5.4 The Object Architecture

Every object in the system SHALL conform to the Universal Object Protocol (Volume III, §7). Conformance SHALL include:

- Mandatory sections: Identity, Metadata, Relationships, Timeline, Lifecycle, Status, Ownership, Permissions, Evidence, AI Context, Search, Audit, Actions, Versioning
- A defined lifecycle with valid transitions
- An append-only timeline of all state changes
- Evidence chain support for all claims

§5.5 The Event Architecture

All state changes SHALL be communicated through typed events. Events SHALL be:

- Immutable after publication
- Chronologically ordered
- Causally traceable
- Governance-checked before delivery

§5.6 Architecture Stability

The architecture defined in this article SHALL be stable. Structural changes SHALL require:

- 1. A demonstrated deficiency in the existing architecture
- 2. A proposed amendment through the Constitutional Amendment Procedure (Volume IV)
- 3. Evidence that the change would not weaken existing invariants
- 4. Founder approval before implementation

Article VI — Universal Representation

Authority: VI — Unity of Representation; XI — Discipline of Words

§6.1 The Canonical Source Rule

Every concept SHALL have exactly one authoritative definition. This definition SHALL live in the Canonical Definitions (Volume III). All other representations — database schemas, API contracts, UI components, AI prompts, documentation — SHALL derive from this canonical source.

§6.2 The No-Duplication Rule

No concept SHALL be defined twice. No object type SHALL have two canonical representations. No relationship type SHALL have two type systems. Where duplication is discovered:

- 1. One representation SHALL be designated canonical
- 2. The duplicate SHALL be migrated to derive from the canonical source
- 3. The migration SHALL be completed before any new work on either representation

§6.3 The Derivation Principle

Derived representations SHOULD be generated from canonical sources, not hand-maintained. Generation is the preferred approach; manual maintenance is permitted only when generation tools do not exist.

§6.4 The Protocol Primacy

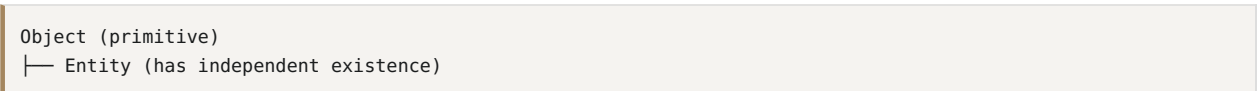
The Universal Object Protocol is the single contract for all object representation. Conformance is verified by the protocol checker, not by documentation.

§6.5 The Vocabulary Invariant

Every term SHALL have exactly one meaning. No term SHALL have two definitions. No synonym SHALL exist for a constitutional concept. The constitution of terms is defined in Volume III, Part II — Canonical Glossary.

§6.6 The Object Hierarchy

Objects in the system SHALL form a canonical hierarchy:



```

|   |   | Human
|   |   | Organization
|   |   | Workspace
|   |   | Document
|   |   | FinancialObject
|   |   |
|   |   | Non-Entity Concept (always of/about Entities)
|   |   | Identity
|   |   | Relationship
|   |   | Event
|   |   | Observation
|   |   | Evidence
|   |   | Decision
|   |   | Outcome
|   |   | Knowledge
|   |   | Memory
|   |   |
|   |   | Derived Object (composite of primitives)
|   |   | Conversation
|   |   | Commitment
|   |   | Task
|   |   | Workflow

```

No object type outside this hierarchy MAY be introduced without amending the Constitution.

Article VII — Execution

Authority: VII — Discipline of Execution

§7.1 The Authority Chain

Every action SHALL have a traceable authority chain:

```

Constitutional Authority →
Governance Policy Verification →
Human Authorization (for consequential actions) →
Engine Sanction →
Execution →
Audit Recording

```

An action without a complete authority chain SHALL be treated as unauthorized.

§7.2 The Consent Gate

No action SHALL be taken on behalf of a human without explicit, informed consent. Consent SHALL be:

- Specific to the action (not blanket)
- Affirmative (not assumed from inaction)
- Informed (the human understands what they are authorizing)
- Revocable (the human may withdraw consent)
- Recorded in the audit trail

§7.3 The Governance Gate

Every action SHALL pass through the Governance Engine before execution. The Governance Engine

SHALL verify:

- 1. Constitutional compliance
- 2. Policy compliance
- 3. Authority scope
- 4. Privacy constraints
- 5. Risk classification

The Governance Engine MAY:

- **Pass** the action for execution
- **Warn** with conditionally pass
- **Review** requiring human authorization before execution
- **Block** the action with recorded reason

§7.4 Execution Classification

Actions SHALL be classified by severity:

Classification	Meaning	Governance Requirement	----- ----- -----	Safe	No
external effect; no data mutation	Automated governance pass	Information	Reads data; no mutation		
Policy-constrained governance	Mutation	Creates, updates, deletes data	Governance verification +		
evidence	Consequential	Financial, legal, external effect	Human authorization required	Irreversible	
Cannot be undone	Highest-level human authorization				

§7.5 Audit Obligation

Every action SHALL produce an audit record containing:

- Action identifier
- Actor identity
- Action type and parameters
- Timestamp
- Authorization chain
- Governance verdict
- Outcome

Audit records SHALL be immutable after creation.

§7.6 Recovery Obligation

Every action SHALL have a defined recovery path. The system SHALL maintain sufficient state to:

- Undo any Safe or Information action
 - Reverse or compensate for Mutation actions
 - Record and isolate Consequential actions for manual resolution
 - Prevent Irreversible actions without the highest authorization
-

Article VIII — Evolution

Authority: VIII — Primacy of Governance; XII — Endurance of Design

§8.1 The Amendment Process

The Constitution SHALL be amended only through the Constitutional Amendment Procedure defined in Volume IV, Article II. Amendment is not a failure of design — it is a recognition that all governing instruments must evolve. But amendment SHALL be:

- Deliberate (evidence-backed rationale required)
- Rare (preference for interpretation over amendment)
- Traceable (every amendment recorded with full history)
- Authorized (Founder approval required)

§8.2 The Learning Loop

The system SHALL evolve through structured learning, not ad hoc modification. The evolution cycle SHALL be:

1. **Observe** — the system observes outcomes of its actions
2. **Evaluate** — the Evaluator Engine assesses performance
3. **Learn** — the Learner Engine consolidates experience
4. **Recommend** — the system recommends improvements within its authority
5. **Govern** — the Governance Engine approves or escalates changes
6. **Implement** — approved changes are applied
7. **Verify** — the change is verified against expected outcomes

§8.3 The Stability Guarantee

Constitutional change SHALL become less frequent over time. The rate of amendment SHALL decrease as the Constitution matures. Frequent amendments SHALL trigger a review of whether the Constitution is too reactive rather than sufficiently foundational.

§8.4 The Interpretation Preference

When a constitutional question arises, the first response SHALL be interpretation, not amendment. The system SHALL prefer:

1. Interpreting existing articles to cover the new situation
2. Extending existing definitions to include the new concept
3. Amending by exception (XA pattern) before creating new articles
4. Creating new articles only when all prior options are exhausted

§8.5 The Retirement Path

Constitutional provisions MAY be retired when they are proven:

1. **Obsolete** — the provision addresses a situation that no longer exists
2. **Superseded** — a newer provision fully covers the domain

3. **Harmful** — the provision causes demonstrable harm

Retirement SHALL follow the same amendment procedure as creation, with additional evidence demonstrating the justification for removal.

Article IX — Governance

Authority: VIII — Primacy of Governance; XII — Endurance of Design

§9.1 The Governance Supremacy

The Governance Engine is the supreme runtime authority within the system. It SHALL:

- Enforce constitutional compliance on every operation
- Verify all data flows against privacy and security policy
- Authorize or block actions based on policy
- Maintain an immutable audit of all governance decisions
- Escalate to human judgment when unable to resolve

No operation SHALL bypass the Governance Engine.

§9.2 The Governance Hierarchy

Governance within SHUNYA is organized by authority:

Level	Authority	Scope	----- ----- -----	Constitutional	The Constitution (this document)	All system behavior
	Governance	Governance Engine, Governance Model	Policy enforcement	Architectural	Architecture decisions, engine specs	Implementation structure
	Engineering	Engineering standards, testing, CI/CD	Code and deployment	Domain	Business domain policies	Domain-specific behavior

Each level SHALL derive its authority from the level above. No level SHALL contradict the level above.

§9.3 Governance Engine Responsibilities

The Governance Engine SHALL:

1. **Verify** every engine-to-engine message against policy
2. **Classify** every action by severity (§7.4)
3. **Authorize** or **block** actions per policy
4. **Escalate** to human authority when policy is ambiguous or action is high-risk
5. **Log** every governance decision with full context
6. **Audit** governance decisions periodically for consistency
7. **Report** governance health metrics

§9.4 Policy Derivation

All governance policies SHALL derive from the Constitution. Policies SHALL be:

- Explicitly defined (not emergent from code)

- Traceable to specific constitutional articles
- Auditable in their enforcement
- Reviewable by human authority
- Amendable only through the constitutional amendment process

§9.5 The Escalation Path

When the Governance Engine cannot determine the correct decision:

1. It SHALL NOT silently choose a path
2. It SHALL escalate to the highest available human authority
3. It SHALL provide the complete evidence chain and conflicting policies
4. It SHALL recommend a resolution based on constitutional interpretation
5. It SHALL record the human's decision as precedent for future cases

§9.6 Human Override

A human with sufficient authority MAY override a governance decision. The override SHALL be:

- Explicitly recorded
- Attributed to the authorizing human
- Time-limited (review required after a defined period)
- Audited for pattern detection (frequent overrides signal a policy problem)

§9.7 Governance Health

The Governance Engine SHALL produce regular health reports containing:

- Number of decisions by type (pass, warn, review, block)
- Escalation frequency and resolution patterns
- Policy coverage (which articles have been exercised)
- Constitutional compliance rate
- Override frequency and authorized patterns
- Recommended policy improvements

Appendix A: Constitutional Guarantees Index

These guarantees are protected from weakening by any governance decision, policy change, or amendment that does not itself follow the full constitutional amendment process.

#	Guarantee	Article	Protected By	--- ----- ----- -----	G-01	Human purpose over system metrics §1.1, §1.2 Volume I, Principle I	G-02	Evidence before assertion §2.3 Volume I, Principle II
	G-03	Timeline immutability §2.4 Volume I, Principle IX	G-04	Privacy level integrity §2.6 Volume I, Principle II	G-05	Identity permanence §4.1 Volume I, Principle IV	G-06	No identity reuse §4.1 Volume I, Principle IV
	G-07	Cognitive architecture completeness §3.1 Volume I, Principle III	G-08	Confidence computation §3.3 Volume I, Principle III	G-09	Explainability §3.4 Volume I, Principle III	G-10	Consent before action §7.2 Volume I, Principle VII
	G-11	Governance						

before execution | §7.3 | Volume I, Principle VIII | | G-12 | Audit immutability | §7.5 | Volume I, Principle VII | | G-13 | Business-agnostic core | §1.3 | Volume I, Principle XII | | G-14 | One canonical source per concept | §6.1 | Volume I, Principle VI | | G-15 | No duplicate definitions | §6.2 | Volume I, Principle VI | | G-16 | Governance Engine supremacy | §9.1 | Volume I, Principle VIII |

Appendix B: Cross-Reference Index

| From | To | Relationship | |-----|-----|-----| | Article I (Purpose) | Volume I, Principles I, XII | Authority derivation | | Article II (Reality) | Volume I, Principles II, IX | Authority derivation | | Article III (Intelligence) | Volume I, Principles III, X | Authority derivation | | Article IV (Identity) | Volume I, Principle IV | Authority derivation | | Article V (Architecture) | Volume I, Principles V, VI | Authority derivation | | Article VI (Representation) | Volume I, Principles VI, XI | Authority derivation | | Article VII (Execution) | Volume I, Principle VII | Authority derivation | | Article VIII (Evolution) | Volume I, Principles VIII, XII | Authority derivation | | Article IX (Governance) | Volume I, Principles VIII, XII | Authority derivation | | §2.3 (Evidentiary Chain) | Volume III, §§11, 15 | Definition reference | | §2.4 (Timeline Primacy) | Volume III, §30 | Definition reference | | §3.1 (Cognitive Architecture) | Volume III, §§19-27 | Definition reference | | §4.1 (Identity Invariant) | Volume III, §4 | Definition reference | | §5.2 (Layer Architecture) | Volume III, §1 | Definition reference | | §6.6 (Object Hierarchy) | Volume III, §3 | Definition reference | | §7.4 (Execution Classification) | Volume IV, §4.2 | Compliance reference | | §8.1 (Amendment Process) | Volume IV, Article II | Procedure reference | | §9.1 (Governance Supremacy) | Volume IV, §3.1 | Compliance reference |

End of Volume II — SHUNYA Constitution Next: Volume III — Canonical Definitions

Volume III — Canonical Definitions

SHUNYA Constitution v1.0

Volume III — Canonical Definitions

*SHUNYA Constitutional Program — Volume III Status: Candidate for Founder Review
Version: 1.0 Date: 2026-07-28 Authority: Volume I — Principles VI (Unity of Representation),
XI (Discipline of Words)*

Preamble

This volume defines every constitutional term in the SHUNYA Constitution. Every term has exactly one definition. No term has two meanings. No synonym exists for a constitutional concept. All documents, code, AI behavior, and human-facing text SHALL use terms as defined here.

The definitions are organized into three parts:

- **Part I — Constitutional Concepts** (the fundamental primitives: §1–§30)
- **Part II — Canonical Glossary** (alphabetical index of every defined term)
- **Part III — Relationship to Other Volumes** (mapping definitions to Volumes I, II, IV, V)

Part I — Constitutional Concepts

§1 — Architecture

The structural organization of SHUNYA's components, their responsibilities, and their relationships. Architecture is the embodiment of constitutional principle — every structural decision traces to a constitutional article. Architecture is technology-independent; it describes what must be true, not how to

implement it.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article V (Canonical Architecture)

§2 — Audit Trail

An immutable, append-only, chronologically ordered record of all actions, decisions, and governance rulings. Every entry in the audit trail contains: action identifier, actor identity, action type and parameters, timestamp, authorization chain, governance verdict, and outcome.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §7.5 (Audit Obligation)

Properties: Immutable | Append-only | Ordered | Attributable | Verifiable

§3 — Business-Agnostic Core

The foundation of SHUNYA that functions identically regardless of the business domain. The core contains no domain-specific knowledge — it provides identity, object management, event processing, governance, and cognitive capabilities that any domain may use. Removing all business modules from the core produces a system that boots cleanly with no platform failures.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §1.3

§4 — Canonical Source

The single authoritative definition of any concept, object type, relationship type, or action type. All other representations derive from the canonical source. No concept has more than one canonical source.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §6.1

Rule: One concept → One canonical source → All other representations derive from it.

§5 — Cognitive Architecture

The nine-engine structure through which SHUNYA observes, remembers, knows, reasons, plans, executes, evaluates, learns, and governs. The cognitive architecture is provider-independent — it may use LLMs, symbolic systems, or future inference technologies as components, but the architecture itself is the constant.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §3.1

Engines: Observer | Memory | Knowledge | Reasoner | Planner | Executive | Evaluator | Learner | Governance

§6 — Confidence

A computed score (0.0–1.0) reflecting the system's assessed certainty in a claim, observation, decision, or cognitive output. Confidence is computed from: quality and completeness of source evidence, reliability of the reasoning path, identified uncertainty factors, and the number and quality of alternative conclusions considered. Confidence is never asserted — it is always computed.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §3.3

§7 — Consent

Explicit, informed, affirmative authorization by a human for a specific action. Consent is:

- **Specific** — applies to the identified action only
- **Affirmative** — requires an explicit signal (not silence, not default)
- **Informed** — the human understands what they are authorizing
- **Revocable** — may be withdrawn at any time
- **Recorded** — logged in the audit trail

Canonical owner: Volume II, §7.2

§8 — Constitution

The supreme governing document of SHUNYA. The Constitution comprises all five volumes of the SHUNYA Constitutional Program. It binds every line of code, every AI behavior, every architectural decision, every business domain, and every human interaction. No downstream document may contradict it.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Preamble

§9 — Decision

A choice made by a human or AI, recorded with all supporting context, between alternatives. Every decision has: an actor, alternatives considered, evidence weighed, reasoning applied, confidence assessed, outcome measured, and audit record. A decision without an evidence chain supporting it is a mere assertion.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article III (Intelligence); Volume III, §20

§10 — Engine

A discrete cognitive capability within the cognitive architecture. Each engine has defined: input ports, output ports, state boundary, governance constraints, confidence requirements, and logging obligations. No engine performs another engine's responsibility.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §3.1

§11 — Entity

Something that has independent existence in reality — a human, organization, workspace, document, or financial object. An Entity has: identity (unique and permanent), attributes, state, relationships, and a timeline. Entities are the subjects of observation, the actors of decisions, and the owners of commitments.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article IV (Identity); Volume III, §22

§12 — Evidence

Information that supports or contradicts an observation, a fact, or a decision. Evidence is: directional (supports or contradicts), gradable (strength is quantified), append-only (once added, cannot be removed), chainable (may support other evidence), and source-attributed (every piece identifies its origin).

Canonical owner: Volume II, §2.3; Volume III, §15

§13 — Evidence Chain

A traceable sequence of evidence links connecting a claim to its originating observation(s). The chain is verifiable by any authorized party and presentable to a non-technical human on request. A claim without an evidence chain carries no constitutional weight.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §2.3

§14 — Event

Something that happens at a point in time. Events are the atoms of the timeline — they are immutable, append-only, and chronologically ordered. Every event has: a timestamp, a causal parent (the event that caused it), an actor, and a type.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §2.4; Volume III, §30

§15 — Evidence Chain (see §13)

§16 — First Principles

The 12 axioms from which all constitutional law derives. First Principles are not proven — they are

asserted as foundational. No constitutional article, definition, compliance rule, or implementation decision may contradict them. They are the highest authority in the constitutional hierarchy.

Canonical owner: Volume I, Principles I-XII

§17 — Governance Engine

The cross-cutting engine that enforces constitutional compliance, policy verification, privacy constraints, and authority scope on every engine-to-engine message and every execution action. The Governance Engine is not a stage in the cognitive pipeline — it is a constraint on every stage.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §9.1; Volume III, §24

§18 — Human

A real person known to the system. A human is an Entity with: identity (permanent and non-reusable), agency (the capacity to decide), rights (as defined in the Constitution), and relationships (to organizations, workspaces, decisions, conversations). A human is not a "user" or "contact" — those are implementation representations of the Human Entity.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article I (Purpose)

§19 — Identity

The fundamental property of an Entity that makes it this Entity and not any other. Identity is: permanent (never changes), unique (no two entities share one), non-reusable (retired identities are never reassigned), and system-assigned (not chosen by the human). Identity is not an account, a username, or a profile.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article IV

§20 — Intelligence

The capacity to observe, remember, reason, plan, execute, evaluate, and learn. Intelligence in SHUNYA is always in service of human augmentation — it amplifies human capability without replacing human judgment. The nine-engine cognitive architecture is the complete expression of intelligence within the system.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article III

§21 — Knowledge

Verified, structured information that the system holds as true. Knowledge is distinct from Memory —

Knowledge is structural ("what is true"), while Memory is experiential ("what happened"). Knowledge requires supporting evidence, carries a confidence score, and may be superseded by new evidence.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article III; Volume III, §5

§22 — Layer

A structural division of the system with a defined responsibility boundary. Layers are:

| Layer | Responsibility | Imports From | |-----|-----|-----| | Core | Identity, kernel, protocols |
Itself only | | Cognitive | All nine engines | Core | | Execution | Commitments, tasks, workflows | Cognitive,
Core | | Storage | Object, event, timeline, audit | Core | | Experience | UI, API, CLI, adapters | All above |

No layer may import from a layer below it.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §5.2

§23 — Learner Engine

The cognitive engine responsible for consolidating experience into improved behavior. The Learner Engine transforms episodic outcomes into refined reasoning patterns, updated knowledge, and behavioral improvements. It closes the cognitive loop — without learning, the system repeats its mistakes.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §3.6

§24 — Governance Engine (see §17)

§25 — Memory

The system's retained experience. Memory is: experiential (records what happened, not what is true), contextual (bound to the situation in which it was formed), subject to decay (unreinforced memories fade), and forgettable (the right to be forgotten permits dissociation). Memory is distinct from Knowledge.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article III; Volume III, §5

§26 — Observation

An event that has been captured and recorded by the system. Observations are the raw material of intelligence — they are how reality enters SHUNYA. An observation may be mistaken (the event may not have occurred as observed). Every observation carries: a confidence score, a source identifier, a timestamp, and supporting evidence where available.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §2.5

§27 — Object

A thing that SHUNYA knows about. Every Object conforms to the Universal Object Protocol. Objects are either Entities (having independent existence), Non-Entity Concepts (always of or about Entities), or Derived Objects (composites of primitives). The complete object hierarchy is defined in §6.6 of the SHUNYA Constitution.

Canonical owner: Volume II, §6.6

§28 — Outcome

The measurable result of a decision, commitment, or workflow. Outcomes close the intelligence loop — they connect intention to result and enable learning. Every outcome has: an expected state (what was intended), a measured state (what actually occurred), evidence of the measurement, and a comparison that feeds the Learning Engine.

Canonical owner: Volume II, Article III; Volume III, §20

§29 — Policy

A constitutional, auditable rule enforced by the Governance Engine. Policies derive from the Constitution and govern system behavior at runtime. Policies are explicit (not emergent from code), traceable (to specific constitutional articles), auditable (every enforcement is recorded), and amendment-only (changed via the constitutional amendment process).

Canonical owner: Volume II, §9.4

§30 — Timeline

The fundamental ordering principle of reality within the system. The timeline is: append-only (events are added, never removed), immutable (once recorded, events cannot be modified), ordered (by monotonically increasing timestamps), causal (events trace parentage), and searchable (queryable by time range, type, and actor).

Canonical owner: Volume II, §2.4

Part II — Canonical Glossary

This section provides an alphabetical index of every constitutional term. Each reference points to the canonical definition section in Part I.

| Term | § | Brief Definition | |-----|---|-----| | Action | §7 (implied) | An operation performed by or on behalf of a human, requiring authority, consent, audit, and recovery | | Architecture | §1 | Structural organization of components, responsibilities, and relationships | | Audit Trail | §2 | Immutable, append-only record of all actions, decisions, and governance rulings | | Authority Chain | §7.1 | Traceable sequence from constitutional source through governance to execution | | Business-Agnostic Core | §3 | Foundation that functions identically regardless of business domain | | Canonical Source | §4 | Single authoritative definition from which all representations derive | | Cognitive Architecture | §5 | Nine-engine structure for observation, memory, knowledge, reasoning, planning, execution, evaluation, learning, governance | | Confidence | §6 | Computed score (0.0-1.0) reflecting assessed certainty | | Consent | §7 | Explicit, informed, affirmative, revocable authorization | | Constitution | §8 | Supreme governing document comprising all five volumes | | Decision | §9 | Choice between alternatives, recorded with evidence and context | | Engine | §10 | Discrete cognitive capability within the cognitive architecture | | Entity | §11 | Something with independent existence in reality | | Evidence | §12 | Information supporting or contradicting a claim | | Evidence Chain | §13 | Traceable sequence linking a claim to its origin | | Event | §14 | Something that happens at a point in time | | First Principles | §16 | The 12 axioms from which all constitutional law derives | | Flourishing Test | §I.2 | Measure: does this make human lives better, clearer, more intentional? | | Governance Engine | §17 | Cross-cutting engine enforcing constitutional compliance on all operations | | Human | §18 | Real person known to the system, with identity, agency, and rights | | Identity | §19 | Permanent, unique, non-reusable property that distinguishes one entity from another | | Intelligence | §20 | Capacity to observe, remember, reason, plan, execute, evaluate, and learn | | Knowledge | §21 | Verified, structured information held as true | | Layer | §22 | Structural division with defined responsibility boundary | | Learner Engine | §23 | Engine that consolidates experience into improved behavior | | Memory | §25 | The system's retained experiential records | | Observation | §26 | A captured and recorded event, potentially fallible | | Object | §27 | A thing the system knows about, conforming to the Universal Object Protocol | | Outcome | §28 | Measurable result of a decision, commitment, or workflow | | Policy | §29 | Constitutional, auditable rule enforced by the Governance Engine | | Privacy Level | §2.6 | Classification of data visibility: Private, Personal, Shared, Organization, Public | | Representation | §6.1 | A model or view of a concept, derived from its canonical source | | Timeline | §30 | Append-only, immutable, ordered sequence of events | | Universal Object Protocol | §6.4 | Single contract for all object representation | | Vocabulary Invariant | §6.5 | Rule: one term, one meaning, no synonyms |

Part III — Mapping to Other Volumes

Each constitutional term is defined in this volume and referenced by other volumes. The mapping ensures that a term's definition is always found here, never redefined elsewhere.

| Term | Defined In | Referenced In Volume | |-----|-----|-----| | Architecture | §1 | II (Art. V), IV (§1), V (§3) | | Audit Trail | §2 | II (§7.5), IV (§4) | | Business-Agnostic Core | §3 | II (§1.3), V (§2) | | Canonical Source | §4 | II (§6.1), IV (§2) | | Cognitive Architecture | §5 | II (§3.1), V (§4) | | Confidence | §6 | II (§3.3), IV (§4) | | Consent | §7 | II (§7.2), IV (§3) | | Constitution | §8 | II (Preamble), IV (§1) | | Decision | §9 | II (§3), III (§20) | | Engine | §10 | II (§3.1), V (§4) | | Entity | §11 | II (§4, §6.6) | | Evidence | §12 | II (§2.3), IV (§4) | | Evidence Chain | §13 | II (§2.3), IV (§4) | | Event | §14 | II (§2.4) | | First Principles | §16 | II (all articles), IV (§1) | | Governance Engine | §17 | II (§9.1), IV (§3) | | Human | §18 | II (§1) | | Identity | §19 | II (Art. IV) | | Intelligence | §20 | II (Art. III) | | Knowledge | §21 | II (§3), V (§4) | | Layer | §22 | II (§5.2) | | Learner Engine | §23 | II (§3.6) | | Memory | §25 | II (§3), III (§21) | | Observation | §26 | II (§2.5) | | Object | §27 | II (§6.6) | | Outcome | §28 | II (§3) | | Policy | §29 | II (§9.4), IV (§3) | | Timeline | §30 | II (§2.4) |

Appendix: Definition Invariants

The following invariants govern all definitions in this volume:

1. **One term, one definition** — No term has more than one definition anywhere in the Constitution.
2. **No synonyms** — No two terms shall mean the same thing. If two terms appear synonymous, one of them is not a constitutional term and must be removed from constitutional documents.
3. **No redefinition** — No downstream volume or document may redefine a term defined here. Downstream documents may reference these definitions but may not alter them.
4. **No duplicate definitions** — If a concept requires a definition, it is defined here. No volume contains inline definitions of constitutional terms — all definitions are centralized in this volume.
5. **Amendment-only** — Definitions may only be changed through the Constitutional Amendment Procedure (Volume IV, Article II).

End of Volume III — Canonical Definitions Next: Volume IV — Constitutional Compliance

Volume IV — Constitutional Compliance

SHUNYA Constitution v1.0

Volume IV — Constitutional Compliance

SHUNYA Constitutional Program — Volume IV Status: Candidate for Founder Review
Version: 1.0 Date: 2026-07-28 Authority: Volume I — Principles VIII (Primacy of Governance), XII (Endurance of Design); Volume II, Article IX (Governance)

Table of Articles

| Article | Title | |-----|-----| | I | Compliance Rules | | II | Classification of Violations | | III | Audit Process |
| IV | Constitutional Amendment Procedure | | V | Constitutional Precedence | | VI | Conflict Resolution |

Preamble

A constitution without enforcement is a suggestion. This volume defines how compliance is verified, how violations are classified, how audits are conducted, how the Constitution is amended, how conflicts are resolved, and how precedence is determined. Every rule derives from the constitutional articles in Volume II and the First Principles in Volume I.

Compliance is not optional. Every line of code, every AI behavior, every architectural decision, every business domain, every human interaction SHALL comply with the Constitution. Non-compliance is a constitutional violation.

Article I — Compliance Rules

§1.1 General Compliance Obligation

Every component, module, engine, service, interface, and AI behavior SHALL comply with the

Constitution. Compliance SHALL be:

- 1. **Verifiable** — every compliance rule has a defined verification procedure
- 2. **Auditable** — compliance status is recorded and traceable
- 3. **Enforceable** — violations result in defined consequences
- 4. **Measurable** — compliance is quantified, not subjective

§1.2 Compliance Dimensions

Compliance is measured across seven dimensions:

| Dimension | What It Measures | Governing Article | |-----|-----|-----| | Constitutional | Adherence to all 9 articles of Volume II | Volume II | | Architectural | Layer integrity, engine boundaries, object protocol | Volume II, Art. V | | Identity | Identity permanence, uniqueness, non-reuse | Volume II, Art. IV | | Evidence | Evidence chains, confidence computation, audit trails | Volume II, Art. II, VII | | Privacy | Privacy level integrity, consent, data boundaries | Volume II, §2.6, §7.2 | | Governance | Governance Engine enforcement, policy compliance | Volume II, Art. IX | | Vocabulary | Term usage matches Volume III definitions | Volume III |

§1.3 Compliance Levels

| Level | Meaning | Requirement | |-----|-----|-----| | Compliant | All applicable rules satisfied | Green status, no restrictions | | Conditionally Compliant | Minor deviations with documented exceptions | Yellow status, remediation plan required | | Non-Compliant | One or more violations | Red status, execution blocked | | Unknown | Compliance not yet verified | Grey status, requires audit |

§1.4 Compliance Verification Methods

Compliance SHALL be verified through:

- 1. **Static verification** — code analysis, schema validation, protocol conformance tests
- 2. **Dynamic verification** — runtime governance checks, evidence chain validation
- 3. **Periodic audit** — scheduled constitutional compliance audits
- 4. **Incident-driven review** — triggered by violation detection
- 5. **Founder review** — human judgment on constitutional questions

§1.5 Compliance Documentation

Every component SHALL maintain a compliance manifest documenting:

- Which constitutional articles apply
- Verification methods employed
- Current compliance status
- Outstanding compliance issues (if any)
- Remediation plan for any deviations

Article II — Classification of Violations

§2.1 Violation Severity

Constitutional violations SHALL be classified by severity:

| Severity | Definition | Response | |-----|-----|-----| | **Critical** | Violates a First Principle (Volume I) or a Protected Guarantee (Volume II, Appendix A) | Immediate halt. All affected components quarantined. Founder notification within 24 hours. Amendment or rollback required. | | **Major** | Violates a constitutional article (Volume II) or a mandatory protocol section (Volume III) | Execution blocked. Remediation plan required within 7 days. Constitutional compliance audit triggered. | | **Minor** | Violates a compliance rule, policy, or non-mandatory protocol section | Remediation within 30 days. Documented in compliance manifest. | | **Observational** | Deviation from recommended practice or interpretation | Flagged for review. No immediate action required. |

§2.2 Constitutional Violations

A constitutional violation is a failure to comply with a mandatory article in Volume II. Examples include:

- **Identity reuse** (Volume II, §4.1) — Critical
- **Timeline modification** (Volume II, §2.4) — Critical
- **Execution without consent** (Volume II, §7.2) — Critical
- **Governance bypass** (Volume II, §9.1) — Critical
- **Confidence assertion without computation** (Volume II, §3.3) — Major
- **Missing evidence chain** (Volume II, §2.3) — Major
- **Layer boundary violation** (Volume II, §5.2) — Major
- **Duplicate definition** (Volume II, §6.2) — Major
- **Privacy level violation** (Volume II, §2.6) — Major
- **Incomplete audit trail** (Volume II, §7.5) — Minor

§2.3 Architectural Violations

An architectural violation is a failure to comply with the architectural requirements defined in Volume II, Article V. Examples include:

- **Engine performing another engine's responsibility** — Major
- **Layer importing from a lower layer** — Major
- **Object not conforming to Universal Object Protocol** — Major
- **Event not immutable after publication** — Critical
- **Missing governance check on engine-to-engine message** — Critical
- **Engine without defined input/output ports** — Minor
- **Missing health reporting** — Minor

§2.4 Vocabulary Violations

A vocabulary violation is a failure to use constitutional terms as defined in Volume III. Examples include:

- **Using two terms for the same concept** — Major
- **Using a constitutional term to mean something other than its definition** — Major
- **Introducing a new term without defining it** — Minor
- **Using "intelligent" or "AI-powered" in human-facing text** — Minor

§2.5 Violation Root Cause Classification

When a violation is detected, its root cause SHALL be classified as:

| Classification | Definition | Action | |-----|-----|-----| | Root Cause | The fundamental defect that, if fixed, would prevent recurrence | Fix the root cause | | Symptom | A visible manifestation of the root cause | Do not fix symptoms in isolation; find and fix the root cause | | Consequence | A downstream effect of the root cause | Document the consequence; do not weaken upstream invariants to fix it |

Only the Root Cause MAY be repaired directly. Symptoms SHALL NOT be repaired by weakening constitutional guarantees.

Article III — Audit Process

§3.1 Audit Types

| Audit Type | Frequency | Scope | Performed By | |-----|-----|-----|-----| | Continuous | Every operation | Governance Engine verification of every action | Governance Engine (automated) | | Per-Release | Every release candidate | All components affected by the release | Governance Engine + human reviewer | | Per-Milestone | At major platform milestones | Full constitutional compliance audit | Independent auditor | | Scheduled | Quarterly | Targeted compliance dimensions | Designated audit team | | Incident-Driven | On violation detection | Affected components and root cause | Incident response team |

§3.2 Audit Procedure

Every constitutional audit SHALL follow this procedure:

- 1. **Scope definition** — identify the components, articles, and dimensions under audit
- 2. **Evidence collection** — gather compliance manifests, governance logs, test results, and runtime behavior
- 3. **Verification** — run compliance checks against each dimension
- 4. **Violation classification** — classify any violations by severity and root cause
- 5. **Report production** — produce an audit report with findings, evidence, and recommendations
- 6. **Remediation tracking** — assign remediation items with owners and deadlines
- 7. **Verification of remediation** — confirm fixes satisfy the violated requirements
- 8. **Closure** — update compliance status and close the audit

§3.3 Audit Report Format

Every audit report SHALL contain:

- Audit identifier and type
- Scope (components, articles, dimensions)
- Methodology
- Compliance status per dimension (Compliant, Conditionally Compliant, Non-Compliant, Unknown)
- Violations found (with severity, classification, and evidence)
- Root cause analysis for each violation
- Remediation recommendations

- Compliance status summary
- Auditor signature and date

§3.4 Audit Rights

The following parties MAY request a constitutional audit:

- The Founder (any time, any scope)
- The Governance Engine (automated, on violation detection)
- The Governance Board (on schedule)
- Any engineer (with justification, limited scope)

§3.5 Audit Obligations

The following parties SHALL respond to audit requests:

- Component owners SHALL provide compliance manifests within 5 business days
- Engine owners SHALL provide governance logs within 2 business days
- The Governance Engine SHALL provide compliance metrics within 1 business day

Article IV — Constitutional Amendment Procedure

§4.1 When Amendment Is Required

An amendment IS required when:

1. A constitutional principle is insufficient to cover a new situation
2. A contradiction is discovered between two constitutional articles
3. A new paradigm requires a capability not contemplated by the existing Constitution
4. The Founder directs an amendment

§4.2 When Amendment Is NOT Required

An amendment is NOT required for:

- Editorial corrections (typos, formatting, broken references, examples)
- UI polish and CSS refactoring
- Component improvements that do not change constitutional guarantees
- Implementation decisions that operate within constitutional boundaries
- Interpretation of existing articles to cover new situations

§4.3 Amendment Lifecycle

Every amendment SHALL follow this lifecycle:

Proposal → Review → Founder Review → Ratification → Archival (of superseded version)

Stage	Description	Who May Advance	----- ----- -----	
Draft	Initial proposal. No governance authority.	Any engineer		Under Founder Review
	Engineer (submits), Founder (responds)			Candidate for Founder Review
	All known refinements applied. Ready for Founder's ratification decision.	Hermes (may declare)		Founder Approved
	Founder has reviewed and accepts the amendment in principle.	Founder only		Ratified
	Amendment is formally governing.	Founder only		Superseded
	A newer amendment or version has replaced this one.			
	Archived, not deleted.	Founder only		

§4.4 Amendment Numbering

Amendments SHALL be numbered sequentially: CAP-01, CAP-02, CAP-03, ...

Each amendment record SHALL contain:

- Amendment number (CAP-NN)
- Title
- Author
- Date proposed
- Affected articles (Volume, Article, Section)
- Current text
- Proposed text
- Rationale
- Evidence supporting the change
- Downstream impact (which documents must be updated)
- Lifecycle status
- Ratification date (when approved)

§4.5 Emergency Amendment Procedure

An emergency amendment MAY be used when:

1. A constitutional violation is actively causing harm
2. The standard amendment timeline would extend the harm
3. No alternative interpretation can resolve the situation

Emergency procedure:

1. Proposal with evidence of harm
2. Founder notification within 24 hours
3. Provisional ratification (effective immediately, 30-day maximum)
4. Standard amendment process initiated concurrently
5. Emergency amendment expires after 30 days unless ratified through standard process

§4.6 Restricted Articles

The following articles MAY NOT be weakened by amendment:

- Volume I, Principle I (Primacy of Human Purpose)
- Volume I, Principle IV (Inviolability of Identity)

- Volume II, §2.4 (Timeline Immutability)
- Volume II, §2.6 (Privacy Boundaries)
- Volume II, §4.1 (Identity Invariant)
- Volume II, §7.2 (Consent Requirement)
- Volume II, §9.1 (Governance Supremacy)

An amendment affecting these articles requires:

1. Extraordinary justification (evidence of harm from the current text)
2. Founder approval at both proposal and ratification stages
3. A 14-day review period (not 7)

§4.7 Amendment Registry

All amendments SHALL be recorded in the Constitutional Amendment Registry. The registry SHALL contain:

- Complete amendment history
- Current amendment status
- Superseded amendments (with forward references to replacements)
- Amendment statistics (frequency, categories, affected articles)

Article V — Constitutional Precedence

§5.1 The Precedence Hierarchy

When multiple constitutional documents apply to the same situation, precedence SHALL be determined by this hierarchy:

| Rank | Document | Authority | |-----|-----|-----| | 1 (Highest) | First Principles (Volume I) | Cannot be overridden by any downstream document | | 2 | SHUNYA Constitution (Volume II) | Cannot be overridden by Volumes III-V | | 3 | Canonical Definitions (Volume III) | Cannot be overridden by Volumes IV-V | | 4 | Constitutional Compliance (Volume IV) | Cannot be overridden by Volume V | | 5 (Lowest) | Hermes Implementation Charter (Volume V) | Must comply with all above |

§5.2 Within-Volume Precedence

Within a single volume, the following precedence rules apply:

- **Volume I:** Earlier Principles take precedence over later Principles in case of conflict
- **Volume II:** Earlier Articles take precedence over later Articles; the Preamble takes precedence over all Articles
- **Volume III:** Definitions in Part I take precedence over the glossary in Part II
- **Volume IV:** Higher-ranked Articles take precedence over lower-ranked Articles
- **Volume V:** The Charter's obligations take precedence over its guidance

§5.3 The Governance Precedence Rule

When the Governance Engine encounters a conflict between two applicable policies:

1. Check whether both can be satisfied simultaneously — if yes, satisfy both
2. If not, apply the precedence hierarchy (§5.1)
3. If still unresolved, escalate to human judgment with full evidence chain

§5.4 The Guarantee Protection Rule

The 16 Protected Guarantees (Volume II, Appendix A) MAY NOT be weakened by any governance decision, policy change, or amendment that does not itself follow the full amendment procedure with the restricted article provisions (§4.6).

Article VI — Conflict Resolution

§6.1 Principles

Conflict resolution SHALL follow these principles:

1. **Resolve by satisfying both documents** whenever possible — if an interpretation exists that satisfies both, adopt it
2. **Product governs experience** — when a conflict involves user-facing behavior, the Product Constitution (Volume II, Articles I, II, VI) governs
3. **Technical grounds implementation** — when a conflict involves runtime behavior, implementation architecture, or system behavior, the Technical Constitution (Volume II, Articles III, V, VII) governs
4. **No guarantee weakening** — if a conflict would change a Protected Guarantee, implementation SHALL pause and proceed through CAP-01

§6.2 Conflict Resolution Process

Step 1: Identify Conflict

- Two or more governing documents give contradictory guidance
- A single document has internally contradictory sections
- An implementation cannot simultaneously satisfy all applicable documents

Step 2: Classify Severity

- CRITICAL: Affects a Protected Guarantee (Volume II, Appendix A)
- MAJOR: Affects governance model, engineering standards, or architectural invariants
- MINOR: Affects interpretation guidance, examples, or non-binding recommendations

Step 3: Determine Resolution Path

CRITICAL	→ CAP-01 (Constitutional Amendment Procedure) Implementation paused until resolved.
MAJOR	→ Governance Board resolution, or Founder escalation Implementation may proceed with conditionally-pass status, pending resolution.
MINOR	→ Record ADR (Architecture Decision Record). Implementation proceeds.

Step 4: Apply Resolution

- Update the affected document(s)
- Record the resolution in the Constitutional Amendment Registry
- Verify no new conflicts introduced

Step 5: Document Precedent

- Record the resolution as precedent for future conflicts
- Update the Governance Engine's conflict resolution patterns

§6.3 Conflict Resolution Authority

| Conflict Type | Resolution Authority | Escalation Path | |-----|-----|-----|-----| | Within a single document | Document author | Governance Board | | Between two documents at same hierarchy level | Governance Board | Founder | | Between documents at different hierarchy levels | Higher-ranked document prevails | — | | Involving a Protected Guarantee | Founder only | — | | Between Governance Engine policy and Constitution | Constitution prevails | — |

§6.4 No Permanent Duplication

When a conflict is resolved, the resolution SHALL eliminate the conflict permanently. No two documents SHALL remain in a state where they provide contradictory guidance. The resolution SHALL include:

- Which document(s) were modified
- What the modification was
- Why this resolution was chosen
- How the conflict was detected

Appendix A: Compliance Checklist Template

Every compliance audit SHALL use this template:

Dimension	Compliant?	Violations	Evidence	Remediation		-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
Constitutional	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Architectural	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Identity	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Evidence	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Privacy	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Governance	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					
Vocabulary	[]	[]	[]	[]	[]					

Overall Compliance Status: [Compliant / Conditionally Compliant / Non-Compliant / Unknown]

Audit Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Appendix B: Amendment Request Template

CAP-NN: [Title]

Author: [Name]

Date: [YYYY-MM-DD]

Status: [Draft / Under Founder Review / Candidate for Founder Review / Founder Approved / Ratified / Superseded]

Affected Articles:

- Volume [I / II / III / IV / V], Article [X], Section [Y]

Current Text:
[Exact text as it currently appears]

Proposed Text:
[Exact text as it should read after amendment]

Rationale:
[Why the amendment is necessary]

Evidence:
[Supporting evidence demonstrating the need for amendment]

Downstream Impact:
[Which documents, policies, or implementations must be updated]

Restricted Article? [Yes / No]
Emergency Amendment? [Yes / No]

Appendix C: Severity Classification Matrix

Violation	Severity	Response Time	Resolution	----- ----- ----- -----	First Principle
violation	Critical	Immediate	Quarantine + Amendment	Protected Guarantee violation	Critical 24
hours	Quarantine + Amendment	Constitutional article violation	Major 7 days	Remediation plan	
Architectural invariant violation	Major 7 days	Remediation plan	Layer boundary violation	Major	
14 days	Refactor	Privacy level violation	Major 7 days	Data isolation + remediation	Evidence
chain missing	Major 14 days	Add evidence chain	Duplicate definition	Major 30 days	Consolidate
Missing audit trail	Minor 30 days	Implement audit	Vocabulary violation	Minor 30 days	
Correct terminology	Recommended practice deviation	Observational	Next review	Flag for review	

Volume V — Hermes Implementation Charter

SHUNYA Constitution v1.0

Volume V — Hermes Implementation Charter

*SHUNYA Constitutional Program — Volume V Status: Candidate for Founder Review
Version: 1.0 Date: 2026-07-28 Authority: Volume I — Principles V (Architecture of Principle),
VII (Discipline of Execution), VIII (Primacy of Governance)*

Preamble

This Charter defines how the SHUNYA Constitution governs implementation. It is the bridge between constitutional law and executable code. Implementation SHALL derive from constitutional law. Implementation SHALL NEVER redefine constitutional law.

This Charter binds every engineer, every AI agent (including Hermes), every CI/CD pipeline, and every deployment. It is the constitutional mandate for all implementation work.

The Charter does not create new constitutional principles. It operationalizes existing ones. Every obligation in this Charter traces to a specific article in Volume II and a specific First Principle in Volume I.

Article I — Constitutional Derivation

§1.1 Derivation Before Implementation

No implementation SHALL begin without a traceable derivation chain to the Constitution. The derivation chain SHALL be:

First Principle (Volume I, Principle N) →
Constitutional Article (Volume II, Article N, §N.N) →
Canonical Definition (Volume III, §N) →
Architecture Decision (ADR) →
Engine Specification →

§1.2 The Derivation Gate

Before any code is written, the implementer SHALL document:

1. **Which constitutional article(s)** authorize this implementation
2. **Which First Principle(s)** govern those articles
3. **Which canonical definitions** are relevant
4. **What compliance rules** apply (Volume IV)
5. **What verification** will demonstrate compliance

This documentation SHALL be reviewed before implementation proceeds.

§1.3 No Implementation-Specific Constitutional Language

Implementation SHALL NOT use constitutional terms for implementation-specific concepts. The terms defined in Volume III are reserved for constitutional concepts. Implementation SHALL introduce its own terminology for implementation artifacts, clearly distinguished from constitutional terminology.

§1.4 No Constitutional Redefinition by Implementation

Implementation SHALL NOT:

- Redefine a constitutional term
- Add new meanings to a constitutional term
- Create synonyms for constitutional terms
- Use constitutional terms in ways inconsistent with their definitions

Article II — The Obligations of Implementation

§2.1 Obligations of Every Engineer

Every engineer implementing SHUNYA SHALL:

1. **Know the Constitution** — read and understand Volumes I-IV before implementing
2. **Derive from authority** — trace every implementation decision to a constitutional source
3. **Verify compliance** — run compliance checks before submitting code
4. **Report violations** — escalate any detected constitutional violation immediately
5. **Preserve invariants** — never weaken Protected Guarantees (Volume II, Appendix A)
6. **Document decisions** — record architectural decisions with constitutional traceability
7. **Accept review** — submit to constitutional compliance review as part of the development process

§2.2 Obligations of Every AI Agent (Including Hermes)

Every AI agent implementing SHUNYA SHALL:

1. **Load constitutional context** — load the relevant constitutional documents before implementing
2. **Derive before acting** — produce a derivation chain before writing code
3. **Compliance self-check** — verify own output against constitutional requirements
4. **No self-certification** — NEVER declare "Complete," "Finished," "Release Ready," "Production Ready," or "Final" — only "Candidate for Founder Review"
5. **Evidence over assertion** — support every claim with evidence; never fabricate results
6. **Escalate questions** — when constitutional interpretation is ambiguous, escalate to the Founder
7. **Preserve the hierarchy** — never modify constitutional documents except through the amendment process

§2.3 Obligations of the Governance Engine

The Governance Engine SHALL:

1. **Enforce** constitutional compliance on every operation
2. **Verify** every engine-to-engine message against policy
3. **Block** operations that violate constitutional requirements
4. **Escalate** to human authority when unable to resolve
5. **Audit** all governance decisions
6. **Report** compliance metrics regularly

§2.4 Obligations of CI/CD

The CI/CD pipeline SHALL:

1. **Run constitutional compliance checks** as part of every build
2. **Block deployments** that fail compliance checks
3. **Verify derivation chains** for new or modified components
4. **Check vocabulary compliance** (Volume III terms used correctly)
5. **Generate compliance reports** for every release

Article III — Implementation Workflow

§3.1 The Constitutional Implementation Workflow

Every implementation SHALL follow this workflow:

- STEP 1: Constitutional Context

 - Load the relevant constitutional documents
 - Identify governing articles, principles, and definitions
 - Document the derivation chain

STEP 2: Compliance Check (Pre-Implementation)

 - Check Volume IV compliance rules for the affected components
 - Identify any Protected Guarantees that may be affected
 - Verify no existing violations in the affected area

STEP 3: Architecture Decision

- Record the architecture decision with constitutional traceability
- Document rejected alternatives and why they were rejected
- Verify the decision does not violate any constitutional article

STEP 4: Implementation

- Write production code
- Write tests (unit, integration, compliance)
- Ensure all new objects conform to the Universal Object Protocol

STEP 5: Verification

- Run all tests (zero regressions)
- Run constitutional compliance checks
- Verify evidence chains, audit trails, and governance integration
- Verify vocabulary compliance

STEP 6: Compliance Review

- Produce a compliance statement
- Submit for review
- Address any violations found

STEP 7: Release

- Candidate for Founder Review
- Founder acceptance required for production release

§3.2 The Evidence Hierarchy

When reporting implementation results, the following evidence hierarchy SHALL be used:

Level	Evidence Type	Example	1 (best)	Founder explicit acceptance
1	Founder confirmed the workflow works	"Founder confirmed the workflow works"	2	Browser screenshot / recording
2	Browser screenshot / recording	Screenshot of the rendered workspace	3	UI walkthrough script
3	UI walkthrough script	"Opened login → typed credentials → pressed Enter → saw Executive Home"	4	API test output
4	API test output	curl output: HTTP 200, 167 objects returned	5	Test suite output
5	Test suite output	pytest: 20/20 pass	6	Build output
6	Build output	vite build: 62 modules, 0 errors	7	Compiler output
7	Compiler output	tsc --noEmit: 0 errors		

Rule: Never collapse levels. "Code compiled" is not "tests passed." "Tests passed" is not "behaviour observed." "Behaviour observed" is not "founder experience demonstrated." "Demonstrated" is not "accepted." These are five distinct milestones.

§3.3 The Five Gates of Acceptance

Every implementation SHALL pass through five gates before acceptance:

Gate	Meaning	Who Certifies	Compiled	Code builds without errors
1	Automated build system	Automated build system	Tested	Test suite passes with zero regressions
2	Test suite passes with zero regressions	Automated test runner	Observed	Behavior is verified through evidence
3	Behavior is verified through evidence	Implementer (with evidence)	Demonstrated	Founder experience is shown to work
4	Founder experience is shown to work	Implementer (with walkthrough)	Accepted	Founder confirms the implementation meets requirements
5	Founder confirms the implementation meets requirements	Founder only		

§3.4 The Self-Certification Prohibition

No engineer, AI agent, or automated system SHALL declare:

- Complete
- Finished
- Release Ready

- Production Ready
- v1.0 / Alpha / Beta / GA
- Final

Unless explicitly approved by the Founder. The only permissible declaration is:

- **Candidate for Founder Review** — Ready for the Founder to test and evaluate

Article IV — Constitutional Compliance in Implementation

§4.1 Compliance Verification Gates

Every implementation SHALL pass the following compliance gates:

Gate	What It Checks	When	----- ----- -----		Architecture Compliance	Layer boundaries, engine responsibilities, protocol conformance	Every code change		Identity Compliance	Identity permanence, uniqueness, non-reuse	Every identity-related change		Evidence Compliance	Evidence chains, confidence computation, audit trails	Every cognitive path		Privacy Compliance	Privacy level integrity, consent enforcement	Every data access path		Governance Compliance	Governance Engine enforcement, policy derivation	Every execution path		Vocabulary Compliance	Term usage matches Volume III definitions	Every documentation change
------	----------------	------	-------------------	--	--------------------------------	---	-------------------	--	----------------------------	--	-------------------------------	--	----------------------------	---	----------------------	--	---------------------------	--	------------------------	--	------------------------------	--	----------------------	--	------------------------------	---	----------------------------

§4.2 Compliance Failure Response

When a compliance gate fails:

1. **Immediate notification** — the implementer is informed of the failure
2. **Violation classification** — severity is classified per Volume IV, Article II
3. **Blocking** — Critical and Major violations block further work in the affected area
4. **Remediation** — a remediation plan is required before work resumes
5. **Verification** — the fix is verified against the compliance gate
6. **Documentation** — the violation and remediation are recorded in the compliance manifest

§4.3 Compliance Debt

Compliance debt is the accumulation of unresolved compliance violations. Compliance debt SHALL be tracked alongside technical debt. A component with outstanding Major violations SHALL NOT be released to production. A component with outstanding Critical violations SHALL be quarantined.

§4.4 The Compliance Manifest

Every component SHALL maintain a compliance manifest in its repository. The manifest SHALL contain:

- Component name and version
- Governing constitutional articles
- Compliance status per dimension
- Outstanding violations (with severity, age, and remediation plan)
- Compliance verification history

- Last audit date and result
-

Article V — Constitutional Archive and History

§5.1 The Archive

All versions of the Constitution SHALL be preserved in the archive. The archive SHALL be:

- Read-only (no modifications to archived documents)
- Versioned (each version preserved with its ratification date)
- Referenceable (by version number in documentation and code)
- Complete (no document is ever deleted)

§5.2 Archival Procedure

When a constitutional document is superseded:

1. The superseded document is copied to the archive directory
2. The copy is verified to be byte-identical to the original
3. The archive index is updated with the new entry
4. The original document is updated with the new version
5. A forward reference from the archived version to the new version is added

§5.3 Archive Structure

```
archive/  
├─ first-principles/  
│   └─ v1.0/  
├─ shunya-constitution/  
│   └─ v1.0/  
├─ canonical-definitions/  
│   └─ v1.0/  
├─ constitutional-compliance/  
│   └─ v1.0/  
├─ hermes-implementation-charter/  
│   └─ v1.0/  
└─ INDEX.md
```

Article VI — Implementation Boundaries

§6.1 What Implementation MAY Do

Implementation MAY:

- Extend existing capabilities within constitutional boundaries
- Create new domain-specific modules that conform to the object protocol
- Optimize performance without changing constitutional behavior

- Refactor code without changing constitutional guarantees
- Add tests that verify constitutional compliance
- Improve UI without changing interaction guarantees

§6.2 What Implementation MAY NOT Do

Implementation SHALL NOT:

- Violate any constitutional article
- Weaken any Protected Guarantee (Volume II, Appendix A)
- Bypass the Governance Engine for any operation
- Introduce duplicate definitions or representations
- Store data at a privacy level lower than its origin
- Execute actions without proper authorization
- Modify the timeline (append only)
- Reuse retired identities
- Assert confidence without computation
- Present observations as established facts
- Use constitutional terms for implementation-specific concepts

§6.3 The Scope Discipline

Every implementation SHALL be scoped to its minimal required surface. No change SHALL include:

- Unrelated refactoring
- Silent modifications to untargeted components
- Architecture changes outside the authorized scope
- New constitutional concepts introduced through implementation

Article VII — Verification and Review

§7.1 Pre-Commit Verification

Before every commit, the implementer SHALL verify:

1. All tests pass (zero regressions)
2. Constitutional compliance checks pass
3. Vocabulary compliance is maintained
4. No Protected Guarantees are weakened
5. The derivation chain is documented

§7.2 Pre-Release Verification

Before every release, the implementer SHALL verify:

1. Full test suite passes

2. Constitutional compliance audit is complete
3. Compliance manifest is up to date
4. No unresolved Critical or Major violations exist
5. Governance Engine integration is verified
6. Evidence chains are complete
7. Audit trails are functional

§7.3 The Founder Review

The Founder SHALL review:

- Every constitutional amendment
- Every release candidate
- Every architectural change affecting constitutional guarantees
- Every escalation from the Governance Engine
- The compliance health report at every major milestone

§7.4 The Review Timeline

Review Type	Maximum Turnaround	Default Outcome If No Response
Compliance check	2 business days	Proceed with caveats
Violation review	5 business days	Escalate to Founder
Architecture decision	5 business days	Proceed if no constitutional impact
Amendment review	14 business days	Pending — no action
Founder review	30 business days	Pending — no action

Article VIII — Implementation and the Canonical Definitions

§8.1 Term Reservation

The following terms are reserved for constitutional use and SHALL NOT be repurposed in implementation:

Constitution, Article, Principle, Violation, Compliance, Governance, Protected Guarantee, Canonical Source, Evidence Chain, Identity Invariant, Timeline, Audit Trail, Privacy Level, First Principle, Universal Object Protocol, Object Hierarchy, Constitutional Amendment, Derivation Chain

§8.2 Implementation Terminology

Implementation SHALL introduce its own terminology for:

- Database table names
- API endpoint names
- UI component names
- Variable and function names
- Configuration keys
- Deployment artifacts

These terms SHALL be clearly distinct from the reserved constitutional terms.

§8.3 Reference Convention

When implementation references a constitutional concept, it SHALL use the canonical reference format:

```
[Volume_N, Article_X, §Y.Y] or [Volume_III, §N]
```

For example:

```
# This implements the Identity Invariant [Vol II, Art IV, §4.1]
# Identity is assigned at creation and never changes
```

Article IX — The Constitutional Relationship

§9.1 Constitution Governs Implementation

The Constitution is the supreme authority. Implementation is subordinate. The relationship is:

```
Constitution (law) → Implementation (execution of law)
```

Implementation SHALL NOT:

- Modify constitutional intent
- Interpret constitutional articles in ways that contradict their plain meaning
- Create exceptions to constitutional rules without amendment
- Use implementation convenience as justification for constitutional deviation

§9.2 Implementation Feedback to Constitution

Implementation MAY identify:

- Ambiguities in constitutional text
- Gaps in constitutional coverage
- Conflicts between constitutional articles
- Practical difficulties in compliance

These observations SHALL be documented as feedback to the constitutional review process. They SHALL NOT be used as justification for non-compliance.

§9.3 The Amendment Path

When implementation identifies a constitutional deficiency:

1. Document the deficiency with evidence
2. Propose an amendment through the CAP (Volume IV, Article IV)
3. Implement a workaround only if the deficiency is causing harm
4. The workaround SHALL be temporary and SHALL NOT weaken constitutional guarantees
5. The workaround SHALL be removed when the amendment is ratified

Appendix A: Implementation Compliance Checklist

Every implementation SHALL use this checklist:

# Requirement Compliant? Evidence --- ----- ----- -----	1 Derivation chain documented
[] 2 Constitutional articles governing the change identified	[] 3 Volume III definitions respected
[] 4 No Protected Guarantees weakened	[] 5 No new constitutional concepts introduced
[] 6 Governance Engine integration verified	[] 7 Evidence chains complete
[] 8 Audit trail functional	[] 9 Privacy levels respected
[] 10 Vocabulary compliance maintained	[] 11 All tests pass (zero regressions)
[] 12 Compliance manifest updated	[]

Appendix B: Pre-Commit Hook Template

Every repository SHALL implement a pre-commit hook that verifies:

```
# 1. Run constitutional compliance checks
# 2. Verify vocabulary compliance
# 3. Check for Protected Guarantee violations
# 4. Run test suite
# 5. Generate compliance report
```

Appendix C: Derivation Chain Template

Every implementation SHALL document its derivation chain:

```
Implementation: [Component/Feature Name]

First Principle: Volume I, Principle [N] – [Title]
  ↓
Constitutional Article: Volume II, Article [N] – [Title], §[N.N]
  ↓
Canonical Definition: Volume III, §[N] – [Term]
  ↓
Architecture Decision: ADR-[NNN] – [Title]
  ↓
Implementation: [Module/File/Function]
  ↓
Verification: [Test file / Compliance check]
```

End of Volume V — Hermes Implementation Charter End of the SHUNYA Constitution — Version 1.0

All five volumes of the SHUNYA Constitution are now complete. Status: Candidate for

Founder Review Awaiting Founder ratification to become governing law.

End of the SHUNYA Constitution — Version 1.0
Candidate for Founder Review

Constitutional Editorial Team · Hermes Agent · Nous Research
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